

SKILLS GUIDE



The ability to work with people from all walks of life, and to understand their individual needs.



Good team-working skills for collaborating with the agencies involved in offender care.



The ability to listen, negotiate, and remain calm when dealing with challenging behavior.



An organized approach and the ability to prioritize work for handling several cases at once.



The ability to make objective and analytical assessments of behavior and circumstances.



TREATMENT PROGRAM DIRECTOR Oversees the running of a program and/or facility that provides treatment for offenders who have recently left prison, or inmates who are undergoing treatment for addiction.



PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT OFFICER Advises and guides ex-offenders through the options available to them regarding education, training, and work, and helps them integrate into society following a prison term.

RELATED CAREERS

- ▶ **POLICE OFFICER** *see pp. 240–241*
- ▶ **CORRECTIONS OFFICER** *see pp. 242–243*
- ▶ **COUNSELOR** *see pp. 256–257*
- ▶ **SOCIAL WORKER** *see pp. 258–259*
- ▶ **FORENSIC PSYCHOLOGIST** Works with offenders in prisons and in the community to devise and deliver treatment programs that will counter antisocial behavior. They also carry out research to profile and understand criminal behavior, and may give expert testimony in court and advise parole boards and police forces.

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Sociology and social work • Law • Psychology • Politics • Counseling • English • Mathematics • Information Technology (IT)



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS Entry requirements vary, but a degree and vocational training in probation work are usually required.



LIFESTYLE Office hours are regular, but probation officers may need to work late or on weekends to deal with heavy caseloads or when on call.



LOCATION The work of a probation officer is mainly office-based, but they may need to travel frequently to courts, police stations, and prisons.



THE REALITIES Making positive changes to people's lives is satisfying, but dealing with offenders and victims of crime can be distressing.